

A person wearing a white lab coat is shown from the chest down, holding their hands together. Between their hands is a vibrant, glowing energy field with swirling lines of purple, blue, green, and yellow light. The background is a soft, out-of-focus mix of warm colors like orange and yellow, suggesting a window or a bright light source. The overall mood is serene and mystical.

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

# SETTLE

*a guide back to your body  
when everything feels like too much*

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[ilikeitdeep.us](http://ilikeitdeep.us)





# Welcome

**You are not broken.**

**Your body is just trying to protect you.**

If you shut down, snap, cry out of nowhere, or feel like you're floating outside your own body, that's not a personality flaw. That's your nervous system doing its job, just a little too well.

This journal isn't about calming down. It's about learning what your body is telling you, and giving it real tools to feel safe again.

There's no wrong way to use this. Some days you'll do every page. Some days you'll do one line. Both count.





# The Basics

*Your body has 4 main reactions to stress:*

## **Fight**

irritable, snappy, on edge, ready to argue

## **Flight**

restless, anxious, can't sit still, mind racing

## **Freeze**

numb, foggy, stuck, can't make a decision

## **Fawn**

people-pleasing, saying yes when you mean no, over-apologizing

None of these are bad. They're your body trying to keep you safe based on things that happened before. The goal isn't to never feel these, it's to notice them faster and have a way back.







# 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding

**5 things you can SEE**

**4 things you can TOUCH**

**3 things you can HEAR**

**2 things you can SMELL**

**1 thing you can TASTE**

When your mind is racing or you feel outside your body, slow down  
and name each one.

*How did your body feel, before and after?*

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# Box Breathing

**Breathe in — 4 counts**

**Hold — 4 counts**

**Breathe out — 4 counts**

**Hold — 4 counts**

Repeat this box shape of breathing four times, slowly.

*How did your body feel, before and after?*

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# Temperature Shift

**Splash cold water on your face or wrists**

**Hold something cold, like ice**

**Wrap up in something warm and heavy**

Cold or warm sensations can interrupt a panic spiral fast. Try one and notice the shift.

*How did your body feel, before and after?*

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# Body Scan

**Starting at your head, moving down to your feet,  
where is your body holding tension right now?**

Jaw   Shoulders   Chest   Stomach   Hands   Legs   Other

What does that tension feel like?

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If that tense spot could talk, what would it say?

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# Which One Is Me Today?

*Check-In 1*

**Today I feel most like:**

Fight   Flight   Freeze   Fawn   Actually Okay

**My body feels:**

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**On a scale of 1-10, how activated am I?**

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**One thing that might have triggered this:**

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*"I am allowed to take up time to regulate."*







# Which One Is Me Today?

*Check-In 2*

**Today I feel most like:**

Fight   Flight   Freeze   Fawn   Actually Okay

**My body feels:**

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**On a scale of 1-10, how activated am I?**

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**One thing that might have triggered this:**

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# Which One Is Me Today?

*Check-In 3*

**Today I feel most like:**

Fight   Flight   Freeze   Fawn   Actually Okay

**My body feels:**

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**On a scale of 1-10, how activated am I?**

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**One thing that might have triggered this:**

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*"I can feel activated and still be safe."*







# Which One Is Me Today?

*Check-In 4*

**Today I feel most like:**

Fight   Flight   Freeze   Fawn   Actually Okay

**My body feels:**

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**On a scale of 1-10, how activated am I?**

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**One thing that might have triggered this:**

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# Which One Is Me Today?

*Check-In 5*

**Today I feel most like:**

Fight   Flight   Freeze   Fawn   Actually Okay

**My body feels:**

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**On a scale of 1-10, how activated am I?**

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**One thing that might have triggered this:**

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# Daily Regulation Tracker

Date:

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Morning check-in (1-10):

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Midday check-in (1-10):

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Evening check-in (1-10):

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**What helped me today:**

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**What made it harder today:**

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**One kind thing I did for my body:**

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# Build Your Toolkit

*Everyone's nervous system responds to different things.*

*Fill this in as you figure out what works for YOU.*

**Things that ground me:**

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**Things that help me feel safe:**

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**People or places that relax my body:**

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# Affirmations

*“My body is not my enemy.”*

*“I am allowed to take up time to regulate.”*

*“Not every alarm bell is a real threat.”*

*“I can feel activated and still be safe.”*

*“Healing isn't linear, and neither is calm.”*



*“Not every alarm bell is a real threat.”*





## Keep Coming Back

You don't have to be calm all the time to be healing. You just have to keep coming back to your body, gently, over and over. That's what this journal is for. Not perfection, just practice.

